

Trophy

Williams Banks the Trophy in Sintra

Gregg Williams led the TEG 15 Trophy from the fourth hole of the opening round at Estoril, won three of the four rounds outright, and had the thing settled long before Oitavos Dunes.

Gregg Williams won the TEG 15 Trophy on 157 points, finishing 21 clear of runner-up Stuart Neumann across the four rounds on the Lisbon Coast. He took the lead at the fourth hole of Round 1 and was never afterwards asked to hand it back.

The defining round of the trip came on the Monday at Penha Longa, the Atlantic course at Sintra, where Williams signed for 82 gross. That is a Penha Longa course record. The previous mark of 86 had stood through six prior visits and was presumed safe. It was also a personal best gross round for Williams at +10, and it removed 14 strokes from the 96 he had posted on his only previous visit to the course. He won three rounds outright. Nobody stopped him, though several appeared to be trying to draw attention away from themselves.

The rest was steady rather than spectacular by that standard. He opened with 86 at Estoril, a course new to the field, and closed with 91 at Oitavos Dunes, two strokes better than the 93 he managed there in TEG 8 and a course best for him.

The one clear blemish came in Round 2 at West Cliffs. Williams arrived at the par-five 15th and left it with a 10. The quintuple bogey returned no Stableford points at all, which is a rare thing to achieve while still holding the tournament in your hand. It left him with 88 for the round. Given the eventual margin, it cost him nothing but the scorecard. By the time he reached Oitavos Dunes on the Tuesday, the Trophy had stopped being a contest and become an appointment.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Gregg Williams (4th Trophy) Runner-up: Stuart Neumann
Green Jacket Gregg Williams (1st Jacket) Runner-up: Jon Baker
Wooden Spoon Alex Baker (2nd Spoon) Next above: David Mullin

FINAL · Trophy
GW 157 | SN 136 | JP 135 | JB 131 | DM 125 | AB 114
FINAL · Green Jacket
GW +63 | JB +92 | DM +93 | JP +113 | SN +128 | AB +134

Williams's First Jacket, Won By Twenty-Nine

Gregg Williams had never won a Green Jacket; he won all four rounds of this one and finished 29 clear of Jon Baker at +63.

Gregg Williams had never won a Green Jacket. He now has one, and he acquired it in a manner that discourages debate: a gross total of +63, the TEG 15 Green Jacket by 29 strokes from Jon Baker, and every single round of the gross won. It is the best gross total of his career.

The third round at Penha Longa settled it. Williams went round in 82 gross, +10, a new

course record, beating the previous mark of 86 established across six prior visits. It stands as the best gross round of his career. It was also a fourteen-stroke improvement on his own previous best at the mountain parkland course, the 96 he posted on his first visit there. He closed with 91 at Oitavos Dunes, two better than his previous best there. The 82 had already made the closing round decorative.

Baker was the nearest challenger and had genuine moments, including an 85 at Penha Longa, six strokes better than his previous best on the course, and a 94 at Oitavos Dunes. The trouble had been arranged a day earlier at West Cliffs, where he ran up an 11 at the par-four 17th. A septuple bogey, and the worst score he has recorded on a par four. Against a leader in that form, one such hole is not a setback. It is a resignation.

David Mullin

Mullin Eagles, Then Falls Apart at Oitavos

David Mullin came to Portugal holding both TEG 14 titles, made the only eagle anyone managed, and finished with the worst round and worst gross round of his TEG career.

David Mullin produced the single most eye-catching swing of TEG 15 and also its most punishing collapse. He is a man of nine Green Jackets and the defending Trophy champion, and he conducted both halves of this with the same unruffled bearing.

The high point came at West Cliffs in round two, where he holed out for a three at the par-5 15th. It was the only eagle struck by anyone in the tournament. The same round contained a 10 at the par-5 6th, a quintuple bogey worth nothing whatsoever, and by the 11th, a triple bogey at another blank hole, Mullin had slipped from fourth to last in the TEG 15 Wooden Spoon race.

Round three at Penha Longa opened as well as any stretch of his four days: par, birdie, par for 10 points through three holes. Then a triple bogey at the 4th, the hardest hole on the card, closed the account. He still signed for 85 gross there, one stroke better than his previous best at the course.

Oitavos Dunes undid all of it. Mullin began with a quadruple-bogey 8 at the 1st and finished with another 8 at the 18th, closing with four consecutive holes without a net par. The round came in at 22 points and +33 gross, both the worst figures of his TEG career to date. His 104 at Oitavos was 16 strokes worse than the 88 he had managed on his only previous visit. He remains the defending champion, which is a fact, and this remains the worst round he has ever played, which is also a fact.

Wooden Spoon | Alex Baker

The Spoon Stays in the Family

Alex Baker takes the Wooden Spoon straight from his brother Jon Baker on 114 points, 11 adrift of anyone else, after making an 11 and two 10s across Rounds 2 and 3.

Alex Baker finished on 114 points and collected the TEG 15 Wooden Spoon, taking it directly from his brother Jon, the holder, which at least keeps the item in the family. The damage was concentrated rather than spread. Two rounds, and inside those rounds two short stretches, did nearly all of the work.

The first came at West Cliffs in round two, on a links course none of the field had played before. At the 6th, a par 5, Alex Baker signed for an 11: a sextuple bogey, and the worst he has recorded on a par 5. He followed it with a 9 at the 7th and a 7 at the 8th. Thirteen shots dropped in three holes, and not a net par to show for any of it. Later the same afternoon he took 10 at the 17th. The round came to 110 gross, which under the circumstances counts as containment.

Penha Longa the next day produced the same shape in a different setting. Nine at the 12th, six at the 13th and 10 at the 14th cost him 12 shots across three holes, again with no net par among them. He still signed for 106, matching precisely the gross he made here on his previous visit in TEG 8. Consistency of a sort.

The closing round offered something better. His 103 at Oitavos Dunes was a shot inside the 104 he posted there in TEG 8, a course best, arriving one round too late to trouble the standings or the destination of the Spoon.

Stuart Neumann

Neumann Turns 115 Into Second Place

Stuart Neumann's West Cliffs round contained an 11, two 9s and a 10, and he still finished second in the Trophy — better than any of his last four TEGs.

Stuart Neumann's TEG 15 was built on holes that got away from him. It began at Estoril, where a 9 at the par-four 3rd was followed by a 10 at the par-four 15th. Six over on a single hole, and the worst he has recorded on a par four. He signed for 106 on a course none of the field had played before.

Round 2 at West Cliffs, another first visit, was worse. Stuart made an 8 at the 4th, a 10 at the par-five 6th, an 11 at the par-five 13th, a 9 at the 14th and a 9 at the 17th. Five holes, 26 shots over par between them, not one of them returning a point. The 9 at the 14th, the hardest hole on the card, dropped him to the bottom of the TEG 15 Wooden Spoon race. His gross total was 115. He kept playing. That should be noted.

Penha Longa turned it round. Stuart shot 92, seven strokes better than his 99 there in TEG 8 and a course best, with three straight pars-or-better against his handicap at the 14th, 15th and 16th worth nine points.

The pattern had not gone away, though. At Oitavos Dunes he closed with a 9 at the 18th, part of a 99 that left him four shots off the 95 he managed there in TEG 8. A man can drop 26 shots across five holes and still finish second in the Trophy. That is not a remark about Neumann. It is a remark about everybody else.

John Patterson

Nineteen Points, Then a Ten

John Patterson gathered 19 points in six holes at Penha Longa, which only sharpened the contrast with a final round that opened with a sextuple-bogey 10 at the 1st.

For six holes on the Monday at Penha Longa, John Patterson played better than anyone else managed across the four days. From the 3rd to the 8th of round three he collected 19 Stableford points: pars at the 3rd, 5th, 6th and 7th, the last of those a four-pointer on the stroke index 4 short hole, and bogeys at the 4th and 8th that still banked three apiece.

The course then asked for it back, with interest. The 9th, 10th and 11th cost him eight shots against par, including a quadruple-bogey 8 at the 10th, and the stroke index 1 16th took a quintuple-bogey 9. He signed for a 99, his best gross of the tournament, on a course he was seeing for the first time.

Tuesday at Oitavos Dunes began worse. Patterson took 10 on the opening par 4, a sextuple bogey, then added double bogeys at the 2nd and the 3rd. Ten shots gone in three holes, no net par among them, and the round barely under way. The middle stretch was the same story told again: doubles at the 9th, 10th, 11th and 13th around a quadruple-bogey 7 at the par-3 12th, twelve shots dropped across five holes. A quadruple-bogey 8 at the 17th completed the paperwork. His 105 was his highest round of the tournament, and his four blow-up holes there accounted for 16 shots on their own.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 15

Course Records

- Gregg Williams's 82 at Penha Longa (R3) — a new course record, beating 86; 6 earlier rounds there
- Alex Baker's 106 at Penha Longa (R3) — equals the course-worst, his own mark from TEG 8; 6 earlier rounds there

Personal Bests

- Gregg Williams posts a personal-best Gross round: +10 (R3)
- Gregg Williams's +63 is a personal Gross best
- Gregg Williams — +2 Gross on the Back nine (R3) is a personal-best Back nine Gross

Personal Worsts

- David Mullin's worst round to date: 22 pts (R4)
- David Mullin's worst Gross round to date: +33 (R4)
- David Mullin's +93 is a personal Gross worst
- Alex Baker's 114 pts is a personal Trophy worst
- David Mullin — 10 Stableford on the Back nine (R4) is a personal-worst Back nine Stableford

Rare Feats

- David Mullin eagles the par-5 15th (R2)
- Stuart Neumann runs up a 10 (+6) at the 15th (R1) — his career-worst on a par-4
- Alex Baker runs up an 11 (+6) at the 6th (R2) — his career-worst on a par-5
- Jon Baker runs up an 11 (+7) at the 17th (R2) — his career-worst on a par-4